

LUKOLELA REDD+ PROJECT

Project title	Lukolela REDD+ Project
Project ID	5672
Crediting period	01 March 2025 to 28 February 2115
Project lifetime	01 March 2025 - 28 February 2115; 90-year lifetime
(CCB) GHG accounting period	01 March 2025 - 28 February 2115; 90-year total period
Original date of issue	22-July- 2025
Most recent date of issue	22-July- 2025
Version	Version 1.0
VCS Standard version	VCS standard 4.7
CCB Standards version	CCB standard 3.1
Project location	The Democratic Republic of Congo, Equateur Province, Lukolela territory
Project proponent(s)	Taranis Operations Limited 8 Hanover Square, London, United Kingdom, W1S 1HQ. Bruno Visconti (Corporate investment manager). nbs@taranis.eu
Validation/verification body	To be determined.
History of CCB status	<i>Issuance date(s) of earlier validation statements, dates of previous attempts at validation, etc.</i>
Gold Level criteria	Climate : The Project is expected to reduce emissions by an average of 385'254 tCO ₂ /year, and a total of 11,6 million tCO ₂ during the 30-year first crediting period. The project activities aim to promote community

	adaptation to climate change while supporting economic development in the territories through resource management planning and the development of sustainable agricultural activities. Community : The Project benefits community members in an area of high poverty. The Project fully integrates community consultation and participation in project activities aimed at improving their living conditions and well-being. Activities include capacity building, support for resource management planning, and the development of sustainable agricultural activities. Biodiversity : The project aims to promote habitat and biodiversity protection. Forest conservation and the reduction of pressure on forest resources through community activities will help preserve the remarkable biodiversity of these ecosystems.
Expected verification schedule	Initial verification December 31, 2027
Prepared by	The Shared Wood Company SAS

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1 SUMMARY OF PROJECT BENEFITS

1.1 Unique Project Benefits

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

Outcome or impact estimated by the end of project lifetime	Section reference
1)	
2)	
3)	
4)	
5)	

1.2 Standardized Benefit Metrics

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2 PROJECT DETAILS

2.1 Project Goals, Design and Long-Term Viability

2.1.1 Summary Description of the Project (VCS, 3.2, 3.6, 3.10, 3.11, 3.13, 3.14; CCB, G1.2)

The Lukolela REDD+ Project (hereinafter “the Project”) is a REDD+ initiative that aims to implement an integrated and comprehensive approach designed to reduce carbon emissions by addressing the drivers of deforestation and forest degradation in the DRC, namely slash-and-burn agriculture and charcoal production. The overall objective of the Lukolela REDD+ Project is to draw inspiration from the approaches of the PIREDD Mai-Ndombe (supported by the Forest Investment Program (FIP) and the Central African Forest Initiative (CAFI) with the World Bank as the executing agency), to improve community livelihoods and forest landscape management, thereby reducing greenhouse gas emissions from deforestation and forest degradation in the concession.

The activities of the Lukolela REDD+ Project will be implemented within the conservation concession No. 03/24 (hereinafter “the concession”), located in the Lukolela territory of the province of Equateur, in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC). The Project zone encompasses the entire surface of the concession, covering an area of 217'929 hectares, primarily covered by forests (210'634 hectares) and rural development areas (7'295 hectares). The forests in the concession that were previously intended for logging have been converted to conservation areas.

Situated in the heart of the Congo Basin forests, the concession comprises approximately 22 villages with a growing population of around 34k people, mainly located along its outer boundaries. The Project also acknowledges the presence of Indigenous populations within the concession area, whose rights and interests will be fully respected and integrated into its development. Human activities in the region, particularly agriculture, are causing deforestation that is progressing towards the heart of the concession.

The Lukolela REDD+ project aims to combat deforestation by identifying its various drivers and working closely with local authorities as well as all relevant stakeholders. To this end, it will implement a coherent and coordinated territorial approach, drawing on the different pillars of the Democratic Republic of Congo's National REDD+ Strategy. The project's operational framework includes the following strategic action areas:

- i) Local authorities with enhanced powers will organize land use planning exercises within village communities;
- ii) Trained and motivated technical extension services will monitor and support community forest management;
- iii) Support will be provided for the development of management plans that are adapted to the region's agricultural environment;
- iv) Training and supervision of small-scale foresters will be provided, alongside the dissemination of agricultural techniques to increase yields and incomes for the rural population;
- v) Family planning initiatives will be considered to manage population growth over the medium term;

vi) Rehabilitation of public infrastructure (school and health center) will be supported through Local Development Funds.

As described above, the project's activities aim to achieve ambitious goals in restoring and preserving biodiversity, strengthening communities' capacity for action and supporting their economic development, as well as promoting climate change mitigation. This will result in reduced pressure on forests, which will lead to a reduction in unplanned deforestation and the restoration of forest ecosystems, the development of sustainable and profitable agricultural activities for communities, the establishment of a system that integrates the various communities in an inclusive and participatory manner in the management of concession resources, and the rehabilitation of public infrastructure (schools, health centers, roads, and water sources) that will reduce poverty and the isolation of villages.

The Project is aligned with the national REDD+ strategy, established in 2012, which aims to stabilize forest cover at 63.5% by 2030. It will fully comply with all applicable DRC legislation for REDD+ project development, including submission to the national REDD+ approval process, the securing of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) from local communities, and the completion of a social and environmental impact assessment.

The Project applies the VCS approved VM0007 (V.1.8) Methodology Framework and is expected to reduce emissions by an average of 385'254 tCO₂/year, and a total of 11'6 million tCO₂ during the 30-year first crediting period.

The Project is not located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program.

2.1.2 Audit History (VCS, 4.1)

Audit type	Period	Program	Validation/verification body name	Number of years
Validation	This Project is under development and has not yet undergone validation or verification. The audit history table will be completed prior to validation.	VCS	To be determined	N/A

2.1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type (VCS, 3.2)

Sectoral scope	14: Agriculture, forestry, and other land use (AFOLU)
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AFOLU project category ¹	REDD+ (Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and forest Degradation)
Project activity type	Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation (AUD)

2.1.4 Project Eligibility (VCS, 3.1, 3.6, 3.8, 3.18, 4.1; CCB Program Rules, 4.2.4, 4.6.4)

The Lukolela REDD+ Project is eligible to participate under both the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) Program and the Climate, Community & Biodiversity (CCB) Standards, as demonstrated below.

Under the VCS Program, the project complies with all applicable program rules, including legal compliance, the use of eligible and approved methodologies, and adherence to the latest version of the standard (currently v4.7). The Project respects national laws, regulations, and customary rights in accordance with Congolese legislation, as further detailed in Section 2.5.1.

The Project applies the VCS-approved VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD-MF), version 1.8, which is currently eligible and active under the VCS Program. All relevant modules and tools required by this methodology, including the AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool and modules for baseline determination and leakage accounting, will be implemented. The project uses standardized approaches for demonstrating additionality and establishing baselines and applies all default parameters and factors in full compliance with the VCS Methodology Requirements.

The Lukolela REDD+ Project falls under VCS Scope 14 (Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use) and is classified as an Avoided Unplanned Deforestation (AUD) activity. It aims to reduce GHG emissions primarily associated with slash-and-burn agriculture, charcoal production, and other unsustainable resource uses within the Lukolela conservation concession in Équateur Province. The concession encompasses approximately 217,929 hectares, of which 210,634 hectares are forested lands and designated as the project area. It is designed as a single-location project and does not incorporate grouped project elements that would involve adding new activity instances after validation.

The project start date is 1 March 2025. It will be listed on the Verra Registry within the same year, and validation will occur within the five-year timeframe required for large-scale AFOLU projects under the VCS Program. Prior to validation, the project will complete the required 30-day public comment period, and the validation report and statement will be submitted within one year following the close of this period, in compliance with VCS requirements.

The Lukolela REDD+ Project is also eligible under the CCB Standards. It delivers significant benefits for climate, communities, and biodiversity. Beyond reducing emissions by avoiding deforestation, the project also supports sustainable development through participatory land-use planning, sustainable agricultural practices, family planning initiatives, and investments in infrastructure such as schools, health centers, and roads, contributing to improved livelihoods and social welfare for local communities. In terms of biodiversity,

¹ See Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard

the project aims to preserve 210 634 hectares of tropical forest within the Congo Basin, recognized as one of the world's most critical biodiversity hotspots.

Stakeholder engagement was conducted through inclusive, culturally appropriate consultations, ensuring that Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) is obtained from all relevant communities. A grievance redress mechanism is in place to manage potential conflicts and ensure ongoing dialogue with stakeholders.

Legal rights over the concession are secured through a formal conservation concession contract signed on 5 December 2024 between Equaforest SARLU (now Taranis Congo) and the Government of the Democratic Republic of Congo. Taranis Operations Limited, as the project proponent, is undergoing the REDD+ investment homologation process required under Ministerial Order No. 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MMUOS/2018, which, once completed, will secure exclusive rights over the Emission Reductions generated by the project.

The project does not conflict with any existing VCS or other GHG program rules, and all validation and verification activities will be conducted in accordance with ISO 14064-3 and ISO 17029, ensuring compliance with the VCS Program requirements for third-party validation and verification.

2.1.5 Transfer Project Eligibility (VCS, 3.23, Appendix 2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.6 Project Design (VCS, 3.6)

Indicate if the project has been designed as:

- ☒ Single location or installation
- ☐ Multiple locations or project activity instances (but not a grouped project)
- ☐ Grouped project

The following sub-section is only required for grouped projects. If not applicable, indicate so and delete instruction and headings for sub-section 2.1.6.1 below.

2.1.6.1 Eligibility Criteria for Grouped Projects (VCS, 3.6; CCB, G1.14)

2.1.7 Project Proponent (VCS, 3.7; CCB, G1.1)

Organization name	Taranis Operations Limited
Contact person	Bruno Visconti

Title	Corporate investment manager
Address	8 Hanover Square, London, United Kingdom, W1S 1HQ.
Telephone	+44 7436 800857
Email	nbs@taranis.eu

2.1.8 Other Entities Involved in the Project

Organization name	Taranis Congo
Role in the project	Project Owner - Congolese subsidiary of Taranis Operations Limited, holder of the Lukolela conservation concession rights No. 03/24
Contact person	
Title	
Address	
Telephone	
Email	

Organization name	The Shared Wood Company SAS (sWc)
Role in the project	Technical partner for the project Project Manager appointed by Taranis Operations Limited
Contact person	
Title	
Address	16 rue de l'Arcade, 75008 Paris France
Telephone	
Email	

Organization name	The Shared Wood Company Kongo (sWc Kongo)
Role in the project	Congolese subsidiary of sWc registered in the DRC Technical operator
Contact person	
Title	
Address	
Telephone	
Email	

2.1.9 Project Ownership (VCS, 3.2, 3.7, 3.10; CCB, G5.8)

Land Ownership

The concession rights to the conservation concession No. 03/24 have been granted to Equaforest, later renamed Taranis Congo, subsidiary of Taranis Operations Limited (Project Proponent), pursuant to the signing of a conservation concession agreement on December 5, 2024, between the Democratic Republic of Congo, represented by the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development and Equaforest (now Taranis Congo), for a duration of 25 years.

Project Ownership

The Lukolela REDD+ Project is led by Taranis Operations Limited, acting as the Project Proponent. In accordance with Article 3 of Ministerial Decree No. 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MMUOS/2018 of May 9, 2018 ², which defines the procedure for approving REDD+ investments in the Democratic Republic of Congo, the State has exclusive ownership rights over Congolese Emission Reductions Units (ERUs) and may transfer them to the REDD+ investment holder, if and only if the latter validates the legal homologation procedure imposed by Article 3 of Ministerial Decree No. 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MMUOS/2018 of May 9, 2018.

An irrevocable and enforceable collaboration agreement between Taranis Congo, acting on behalf of Taranis Operations Limited, and the Democratic Republic of Congo represented by the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development has been signed. This agreement sets out the terms and conditions of cooperation between the Parties and their respective rights and obligations in connection with the implementation of the Project. This agreement confirms the government's approval of the Project and acknowledges Taranis Operations Limited's exclusive ownership rights over the carbon credits

² « Arrêté ministériel n° 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MML/05/2019 du 9 mai 2018 fixant la procédure d'homologation des investissements REDD+ en République démocratique du Congo. | FAOLEX ».

generated by the Project, subject to the legal homologation process stipulated in Article 3 of Ministerial Decree No. 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AAN/MMUOS/2018 dated May 9, 2018.

2.1.10 Project Start Date (VCS, 3.8)

Project start date	01/03/2025
Justification	Date of signature of the contract between the project proponent, Taranis Operations Limited, and the project operator sWc. Launch of public consultation activities (awareness and FPIC) and recruitment of project teams. The Project will be listed during the three-year period following the start of the project for validation within five years.

2.1.11 Benefits Assessment and Project Crediting Period (VCS, 3.9; CCB, G1.9)

Crediting period	The project crediting period is 90 years, in line with VCS Standard v4.7 requirements for AFOLU projects, consisting of an initial 30-year period renewable up to three times to reach 90 years.
Start date of first or fixed crediting period	The project has a first crediting period of 30 years from March 3, 2025, to February 28, 2055.
CCB benefits assessment period	The CCB benefits assessment period is 90 years, matching the project crediting period, during which climate, biodiversity, and community well-being outcomes will be monitored.

2.1.12 Differences in Assessment/Project Crediting Periods (CCB, G1.9)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.13 Project Scale and Estimated Reductions or Removals (VCS, 3.10)

- ☐ < 300,000 tCO₂e/year (project)
- ☒ ≥ 300,000 tCO₂e/year (large project)

Complete the table below for the first (if renewable) or fixed crediting period:

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
01-March-2025 to 31-December-2025	378 417
01-january-2026 to 31-December-2026	426 483
01-january-2027 to 31-December-2027	408 476
01-january-2028 to 31-December-2028	402 666
01-january-2029 to 31-December-2029	375 535
01-january-2030 to 31-December-2030	364 806
01-january-2031 to 31-December-2031	371 215
01-january-2032 to 31-December-2032	377 624
01-january-2033 to 31-December-2033	384 032
01-january-2034 to 31-December-2034	390 441
01-january-2035 to 31-December-2035	387 916
01-january-2036 to 31-December-2036	386 111
01-january-2037 to 31-December-2037	384 821
01-january-2038 to 31-December-2038	383 798
01-january-2039 to 31-December-2039	383 454
01-january-2040 to 31-December-2040	383 454
01-january-2041 to 31-December-2041	383 454
01-january-2042 to 31-December-2042	383 454
01-january-2043 to 31-December-2043	383 454
01-january-2044 to 31-December-2044	383 454
01-january-2045 to 31-December-2045	383 454
01-january-2046 to 31-December-2046	383 454
01-january-2047 to 31-December-2047	383 454

01-january-2048 to 31-December-2048	383 454
01-january-2049 to 31-December-2049	383 454
01-january-2050 to 31-December-2050	383 454
01-january-2051 to 31-December-2051	383 454
01-january-2052 to 31-December-2052	383 454
01-january-2053 to 31-December-2053	383 454
01-january-2054 to 31-December-2054	383 454
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	11 557 605
Total number of years	30
Average annual ERRs	385 254

2.1.14 Physical Parameters (CCB, G1.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.15 Social Parameters (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G1.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.16 Project Zone Map and Project Location (VCS, 3.11, 3.18; CCB, G1.4-7, G1.13, CM1.2, B1.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.17 Project Activities and Theory of Change (VCS, 3.6; CCB, G1.8)

The Project aims to implement various activities within the concession by helping communities shift towards activities that reconcile natural resource and forest protection with economic viability, thereby promoting a win-win system. At the same time, previously exploited areas of the concession will be set aside for conservation purposes to ensure their preservation.

The Project targets all populations living within the concession. The Project therefore plans to support community activities in the 22 villages identified in the concession, ensuring that inclusive and representative actions are promoted, with a particular focus on women and indigenous peoples.

The Project is based on eight main areas of action:

- Component A: Establishment of a governance framework,
- Component B: Institutional support,
- Component C: Implementation of planned investments, as identified in the strategic management plans,
- Component D: Other investments in Local Development Committees (LDCs),
- Component E: Development of value chains based on perennial crops,
- Component F: Investments in infrastructure of common interest to restore connectivity between territories,
- Component G: Support for the most vulnerable communities,
- Component H: Support for family planning.

Component A: Establishment of a governance framework.

The formation of Local Development Committees (LDCs) at the village level is essential to the success of the Lukolela REDD+ Project. The Agriculture Act (December 2011), supplemented by an enabling act published in December 2013, describes how all villages located within concessions can be organized into LDCs. Each LDC can represent groups of two to four villages whose territory is under the authority of the same traditional leader (land chief). These LDCs will form councils for agriculture and rural management (CARGs) for each sector and zone (sectoral and zonal CARGs), and it is planned that they will use mapping tools for natural resource and land management.

The basic methodology of the Lukolela REDD+ Project is to strengthen the organizational structure of territorial areas and Decentralized Territorial Entities (DTEs) based on the model of local development committees (LDCs) and agriculture and rural management councils (CARGs) recommended by the Ministry of Rural Development. This strengthening will be achieved through the creation or regeneration of these institutions and their eventual official legal recognition. Traditional political structures, such as the elected members of future DTEs, will work closely with these institutions. The training of the LDCs will be organized and delivered by the Congolese NGO AMAR, which will be responsible for informing and encouraging communities to join the LDCs and then supporting the creation of these LDCs in each territory.

These institutions will be responsible for formulating Natural Resource Management Plans (NRMPs) for village territories. These plans, which will be launched at the level of cultivated village territories up to sectors (DTEs), groupings (based on customary organization) and LCDs, will lead to a collective analysis of the evolution of natural resources and the factors of deforestation and forest degradation. They

result in the planning of appropriate measures to ensure that this evolution is sustainable over time while improving the living conditions of the populations.

The methodology for implementing the Natural Resource Management Plans (NRMPs) includes:

- (i) The delimitation of the main types of vegetation cover using satellite images, validated in a participatory manner;
- (ii) Inventory of land use and tenure patterns;
- (iii) Creation of a mapped inventory of biodiversity and associated threats;
- (iv) Estimation of local communities' agricultural land needs and identification of expansion areas;
- (v) Participatory definition of actions to be taken in the areas concerned (savannah, forests, non-timber forest products, fisheries, flooded forests, infrastructure).

These elements will be developed in a participatory manner to ensure that qualified representatives of all relevant groups participate in program meetings and that their specific interests are understood and addressed separately and specifically in the program. This includes women, youth, indigenous peoples, and vulnerable groups.

The Project takes into account ongoing initiatives on georeferenced village lands, including the Rainforest Foundation UK's "Mapping for Rights" project.

To achieve these results, it will be necessary to:

- a. Establish Councils for Agriculture and Rural Management (CARGs);
- b. Engage Local Implementing Agencies (LIAs), which will be local NGOs, to establish (or re-establish and georeference the boundaries of village cultivated plots;
- c. Train and equip these LIAs;
- d. Create Local Development Committees (LDCs), demarcate their plots and register them;
- e. Verify the socio-environmental compliance of these plans and conduct the necessary socio-environmental studies;
- f. Monitor and evaluate implementation.

Benefits for the community:

Strengthening community structures reinforces community organization and promote inclusive representation in institutions and the project. These LDCs also enable communities to create a forum for discussion on the development of their land. This will strengthen the representation of vulnerable groups and reduce discrimination and inequality.

Climate and biodiversity:

The development of NRMPs will ensure the sustainable and efficient use of resources, enabling the protection and restoration of forest ecosystems and biodiversity by reducing pressure on their resources.

In the long term, these measures will promote carbon storage and climate change mitigation.

Component B: Institutional support.

Decentralized government services need effective organization and adequate resources to fulfill their mission. The validation of management plans and, above all, the smooth implementation of agreements between LDCs are essential to improve the coordination and effectiveness of the teams from the three ministries responsible for village territories (agriculture, environment/forests, rural development).

To implement this component, the Project plans to:

- a. Support the drafting and promulgation of regulations relating to the Agricultural Law of December 24, 2011, which provides for the creation of land advisory councils and their territorial entities at the primary level, implement the draft law recognizing CARG areas, support local development committees (LDCs), organize their functioning and provide support for the implementation of legal provisions relating to the creation and implementation (by the Ministry of Rural Development) of CARGs and LDCs;
- b. Align existing structures with the new regulations, for example by adopting recommendations based on the new law and providing training on the new responsibilities and functions arising from the law, particularly in the land sector;
- c. The Ministry of Environment needs assistance to improve its capacity to supervise forest management activities. Units within the Ministry of Rural Development and the provincial Ministry of Agriculture need to be able to register the status of relevant organizations (i.e., LDCs) and provide relevant registration documents to interested parties;
- d. Establish a complaint and appeal mechanism, either by facilitating access to the courts or by improving the supervision of employees by their superiors;
- e. Strengthen decentralized services through training and the provision of equipment;
- f. Facilitate field missions in villages.

Benefits for the community:

Component B will strengthen public institutions, particularly in the agricultural sector. This strengthening will help preserve the long-term benefits of the project.

Climate and biodiversity:

The creation of LDCs promotes a local and sustainable governance framework for resource management.

Component C: Implementation of planned investments, as identified in the strategic management plans.

This component is implemented through various means, including:

- (i) various forms of training (initial training, field schools, etc.);
- (ii) initial investment and provision of inputs;
- (iii) payment for results or Payment for Environmental Services (PES).

Investments targets traditional smallholders who can benefit from the project on areas ranging from 5 to 20 hectares for plantations and 50 to 100 hectares for protected areas. These farmers must have secure land rights and their land must be located in areas approved by the LDCs.

Various investments are possible, including the development of agriculture in savannah areas (plantations, agroforestry, firebreaks), improving the sustainability of agroforestry, and protecting biodiversity-rich forests.

Benefits for communities:

Component C promotes community economic development by strengthening agricultural activities and infrastructure. These investments aim to improve the quality of life in villages and reduce poverty.

Climate and biodiversity:

Some of the planned activities have significant environmental benefits, including the development of agroforestry and the protection of savannahs against fires. These actions promote the return of biodiversity to areas severely degraded by fire. They also reduce pressure on forests by developing agricultural activities in the savannah.

Component D: Other investments in LDCs

LDCs can receive support in various areas such as co-management of fisheries, creation of fish ponds, and small-scale processing equipment.

Biodiversity:

Component D supports sustainable fishing practices and rational management of fish stocks. Fish stocks are now seriously threatened by population growth, which is putting severe pressure on stock renewal.

Community:

NGOs will provide support for the development of sustainable fishing activities.

Component E: Development of value chains from perennial crops.

The objective of this component is to strengthen or revitalize value chains for local products, particularly rubber, palm oil, coffee, and cocoa. This includes support and assistance to producers to improve the

value of their products, to facilitate the purchase of equipment, to support local processing centers, to promote trade routes, and to develop of fair trade certification. To achieve these objectives, the Project will sign agreements with downstream operators in the sector. These agreements will aim at identifying professional operators willing working at fair prices. These operators are: (i) cooperatives or producer associations, such as the one operating in the cocoa sector (see below); (ii) large private operators already present in the region (forest concessionaires or livestock farmers) who wish to diversify their activities; or (iii) private companies already established in the DRC and wishing to invest in the provinces of Équateur. The Project provides the necessary resources to identify these operators and co-finance their establishment in the region.

Benefits for the community:

The revitalization of the agricultural sectors and value chains will enable sustainable agricultural economic development for the populations.

Climate and biodiversity:

The development of more sustainable agricultural chains reduces pressure on resources and forests.

Component F: Investments in infrastructure of common interest to restore connectivity between territories.

Despite its extensive river network and the significant progress made since 2010 in terms of commercial vessel profitability and substantial investment in this area, entire provinces remain isolated because river boats remain a dangerous and slow means of transport, and trucks have difficulty accessing the province of Equateur. The following priorities have been identified in the area of transport:

- Stricter regulation of river passenger transport and the equipment of these boats (spare engines, night lighting), as well as load control;
- Completion and maintenance of commercial roads within concessions, including the reconstruction of wooden bridges where necessary;
- Maintenance of the most important rural tracks leading to waterways and connecting the main towns in the Lukolela territory.

Benefits for communities:

The economic development of villages is severely hampered by their isolation. Restoring communication links would promote strong economic development and improve access to healthcare and education.

Component G: Support for the most vulnerable communities.

The Lukolela REDD+ Project will support microprojects for indigenous populations within the concession. The Project will ensure respect for the culture and traditions of Indigenous populations through a participatory and inclusive approach.

Benefits for the community:

This component aims to support the most vulnerable communities while avoiding any negative impact on their way of life and traditions.

Component H: Support for family planning

The Project will support the permanent recruitment of local NGOs (one per territory) to promote, in close collaboration with the Ministry of Health, the following activities among the 4,000 farming households in the concession:

- Information/awareness-raising on family planning methods with the support of opinion leaders (political, traditional and religious), combined with access to contraceptive methods. These family planning methods will also be extended to the prevention of Ebola and HIV/AIDS;
- Education for young people, particularly girls, to promote access to employment and the setting of reasonable targets for the number of children per family.

Benefits for the community:

This aspect aims to reduce poverty and improve the health of populations through awareness and prevention.

Benefits for climate and biodiversity :

Awareness of family planning aims to prevent excessive population growth, which would increase pressure on forests.

Based on Social and Biodiversity Impact Assessment Manual recommendations, the following change theories were developed :

BIODIVERSITY - General objective: Preservation of biodiversity

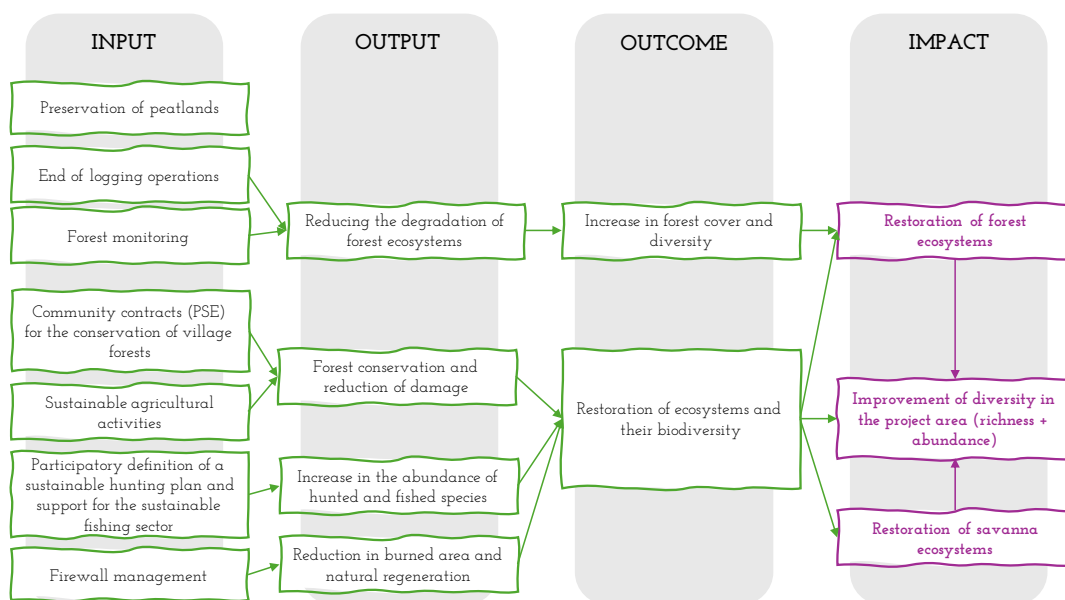


Figure 1: Theory of change for biodiversity - Lukolela REDD+ Project

COMMUNITIES - General objective: contribution to rural poverty reduction

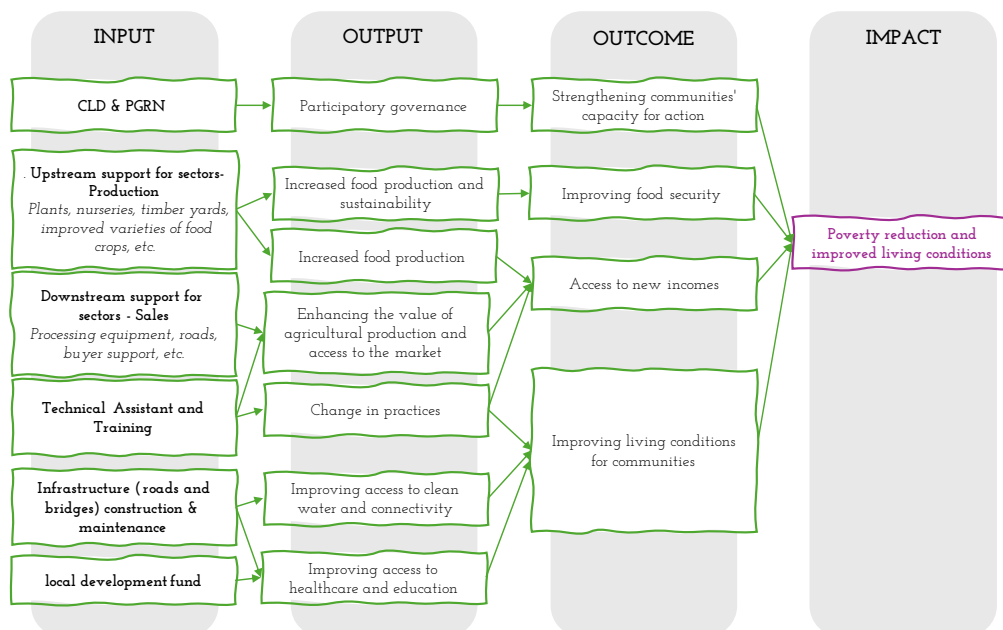


Figure 2: Theory of change for communities - Lukolela REDD+ Project

2.1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions (VCS, 3.17)

The DRC is committed to sustainable development within the framework of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and has adapted the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) established at the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development (Rio+20 Conference). This 2030 Agenda comprises 17 global goals with 169 targets, measured using 232 specific indicators, which address the social, economic and environmental dimensions of sustainable development. In 2016, the DRC established the Congolese Observatory for Sustainable Development, a framework that monitors, evaluates and reports on the implementation of the SDGs. The DRC's strategy is based on an approach that integrates stakeholder awareness and the implementation of public policies with a strong focus on SDGs that incorporate the social dimension. The country also prioritizes the environmental dimension with a commitment to preserving its natural resources. The Lukolela REDD+ Project aims to contribute to these national priorities by promoting the achievement of SDGs that incorporate social and environmental dimensions.

All SDGs integrated into the project are listed in the table below.

Table 1: Sustainable Development Contributions

Row number	SDG target	Net impact on SDG indicator	Project's indicators
Sequential row number	SDG Target number	Indicate the project's contribution to the SDG Indicator (implemented activities to increase or decrease)	Brief description of the quantifiable impact of the project's activities related to the SDG indicator, during the monitoring period.

1) 	1.1. By 2030, eradicate extreme poverty for all people everywhere, currently measured as people living on less than \$1.25 per day 1.2.1.2 By 2030, reduce at least by half the proportion of men, women and children of all ages living in poverty in all its dimensions as defined by each country 1.3.1.5 By 2030, enhance the resilience of the poor and other people in vulnerable situations to, and reduce their exposure to, extreme weather events and other economic, social and environmental shocks and disasters	Reducing poverty is one of the DRC's key national priorities. The project contributes to this objective by promoting the development and diversification of economic activities, particularly in the agricultural sector. The development of these sustainable activities will strengthen community resilience to climate change through (i) the adoption of improved practices to increase food production and (ii) capacity building via trainings. By fostering income-generating opportunities, improving territorial connectivity, and supporting local governance through the creation of LDCs, the project enhances both the economic empowerment and social inclusion of isolated communities.	- Number of ha of agroforest plantations (acacias-manioc); - Number of ha of perennial crops (coffee, cacao, rubber trees, palm oil) in forest areas ; - Number of woodland parcs developed - Number of trainings and technical support for the development of agricultural activities. - Number of LDCs created/rehabilitated in the villages of the concession
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2) 	2.1 By 2030, end hunger and ensure that everyone, especially the poor and vulnerable, including infants, has access to safe, nutritious, and sufficient food all year round. 2.3 By 2030, double the agricultural productivity and incomes of smallholder producers, in particular women, indigenous peoples, family farmers, pastoralists and fishers, including through ensuring equal access to land, other productive resources and inputs, knowledge, financial services, markets and opportunities for value addition and non-farm employment. 2.4 By 2030, ensure sustainable food production systems and implement resilient agricultural practices that increase productivity and production, contribute to the preservation of ecosystems, strengthen resilience to climate change, extreme weather, drought, flooding and other disasters, and progressively improve land and soil quality.	Reducing malnutrition is one of the DRC's priorities. Cases of malnutrition are particularly prevalent in isolated areas of the DRC where food supplies are unstable. The project aims to develop a sustainable food system for communities in the Lukolela concession. To achieve this, the project will work to support communities in developing sustainable and resilient agricultural systems. The project will target small-scale producers and provide them with access to training and technical support (provision of resistant varieties, development of nurseries) and PESs that will increase yields and income while promoting forest conservation. The project will support the development of agricultural value chains (training, provision of processing units, etc.) and thus enable the development of agricultural sectors and reduce hunger. The development of NRMPs will encourage reflection on land and resource use and the introduction of measures to make these actions more sustainable, such as the implementation of hunting management plans. Finally, the Project also aims to promote sustainable fishing by supporting NGOs. This will make fishing activities more sustainable and allow fish stocks to regenerate while meeting food needs.	- Number of ha of agroforest plantations (acacias-manioc); - Number of ha of perennial crops (coffee, cacao, rubber trees, palm oil) in forest area; - Number of processing units installed and trainings organized; - Number of NRMPs developed; - Number of km of roads rehabilitated and bridges built to enhance connectivity.
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3) 	3.1 By 2030, reduce the global maternal mortality ratio to less than 70 per 100,000 live births 3.2 By 2030, end preventable deaths of newborns and children under 5 years of age, with all countries striving to reduce neonatal mortality to no more than 12 per 1,000 live births and under-5 mortality to no more than 25 per 1,000 live births 3.3 By 2030, end the AIDS, tuberculosis and malaria epidemics, and combat hepatitis, water-borne diseases and other communicable diseases 3.4 By 2030, reduce by one-third, through prevention and treatment, the premature mortality rate from non-communicable diseases and promote mental health and well-being	The project aims to achieve this goal by working with local NGOs to run awareness campaigns on family planning and the prevention of communicable diseases (HIV, Ebola, etc.). In addition, the project plans to set up annual Local Development Funds that will be made available to communities, which will be able to decide how to use these funds, particularly for the renovation or construction of health infrastructure.	-Number of households who have benefited from awareness programs on family planning, as well as the prevention of Ebola and HIV/AIDS; -Number of public infrastructure (health centers) financed by local development funds.
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4) 	4.1 By 2030, ensure that all girls and boys complete a full cycle of free and quality primary and secondary education that is relevant and effective for learning 4.2 By 2030, ensure that all girls and boys have access to quality early childhood development, care and pre-primary education that is inclusive and preparatory to primary education 4.4 By 2030, substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent work, and entrepreneurship 4.5 By 2030, eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access for vulnerable persons, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations, to all levels of education and vocational training.	The local development funds mentioned above will also enable the construction of schools at village levels. Throughout the project, particular attention will be paid to the integration of women and indigenous peoples in decision-making and participation in project activities.	-Number of schools financed by local development funds; - Number of trainings organized.
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5) 	5.1 End all forms of discrimination against women and girls worldwide 5.2 Eliminate all forms of violence against women and girls, including trafficking and sexual exploitation, and other types of exploitation, in public and private life 5.4 Recognize and value unpaid care and domestic work through public services, infrastructure, and social protection policies, and promote the sharing of responsibilities within the household and the family, in accordance with national contexts 5.5 Ensure women's full and equal participation and access to leadership positions at all levels of decision-making in political, economic, and public life	Throughout the project, special attention will be paid to gender equality. The project aims to encourage inclusive representation, particularly of women and indigenous peoples. Thus, when the LDCs are created, the project will take care to include women in the committees to ensure their participation in the project's decision-making processes and activities. Special discussion time will be set aside for women so that they can express themselves. An impact assessment will be carried out by the project and will include an important dimension on women's safety, which will enable measures to be put in place to mitigate the risk of violence. The project will prioritize training for women and support gender equality and women's empowerment.	- Number of LDCs created;
7) 	7.2 By 2030, significantly increase the share of renewable energy in the global energy supply	The Project provides support for the establishment of woodlots in villages. These woodlots aim to ensure a sustainable supply of charcoal, the main source of energy in the region, and to reduce pressure on natural forests. The Project will install bases in the concession which will be equipped with solar panels to provide electricity for basic needs.	- Number of woodland parcs created; - Number of bases electrified.

8) 	8.2 Achieve high levels of economic productivity through diversification, technological upgrading and innovation, particularly in high value-added and labor-intensive sectors. 8.3 Promote development policies that foster productive activities, decent job creation, entrepreneurship, creativity and innovation, and stimulate the growth of micro, small and medium-sized enterprises and facilitate their integration into the formal sector, including through access to financial services. 8.4 By 2030, progressively improve global resource efficiency in consumption and production and strive for economic growth that does not cause environmental degradation, as set out in the 10-year framework of programs on sustainable consumption and production, with developed countries taking the lead. 8.5 By 2030, achieve full and productive employment and decent work for all women and men, including young people and persons with disabilities, with equal pay for work of equal value. 8.6 By 2020, significantly reduce the proportion of youth not in employment, in education or in training.	The Project will create jobs in Lukolela with a team including experts and operational staff. In addition, the Project will provide training to strengthen community capacities while ensuring that discrimination is reduced. The Project will also support the development of agricultural value chains, which will lead to job creation in the long term. Finally, through community structuring activities, the project will support the development of representative and inclusive community governance structures that are conducive to community development and job creation in the long term.	- Number of jobs created ; - Number of trainings in value chain and agricultural development.
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10) 	10.1 By 2030, through progressive measures, ensure that the income of the poorest 40 percent of the population increases more rapidly than the national average income, in a sustainable manner 10.2 By 2030, empower all people and promote their social, economic and political inclusion, regardless of age, gender, disability, race, ethnicity, origin, religion or economic or other status	The Project will aim to integrate all populations into activities and decision-making processes, with a particular focus on women, young people, and indigenous peoples. The creation of representative and inclusive LDC will enable vulnerable groups to be included in governance discussions. In addition, the Project plans to finance micro-projects reserved for indigenous populations.	- Number of LDC created which include women, young and indigenous; -Number of micro-project financed.
11) 	11.4 Strengthen efforts to protect and preserve the world's cultural and natural heritage. 11.b By 2020, significantly increase the number of cities and human settlements adopting and implementing integrated policies and action plans toward inclusiveness, resource efficiency, climate change adaptation, mitigation and resilience, and develop and implement, in accordance with the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction (2015-2030), comprehensive disaster risk management at all levels.	The Project activities aim to preserve the natural heritage of the concession. This will notably enable a reduction in deforestation and the preservation of biodiversity in the forests of the Congo Basin. Furthermore, through its inclusive approach, the project also aims to protect the cultural heritage of local populations, with a particular focus on the traditions of indigenous peoples. The structuring of the environment will enable the establishment of an inclusive and representative governance framework that respects natural resources.	- Number of LDCs created; - Number of NRMPs implemented ; - Number of ha of forests under conservation; - Number of hectares of High Conservation Value (HCV) areas protected.
12) 	12.2 By 2030, achieve sustainable consumption and production patterns 12.8 By 2030, ensure that all people everywhere have knowledge and awareness of sustainable development and lifestyles that are in harmony with nature	The creation of natural resource management plans with communities will promote sustainable and rational land and resource planning. In addition, training and structuring activities will incorporate an environmental dimension to raise awareness among local populations about global warming and the importance of forests.	- Number of NRMPs implemented with the communities.

13) 	13.1 Strengthen resilience and adaptive capacity to climate-related hazards and natural disasters in all countries 13.2 Integrate climate change measures into national policies, strategies, and planning 13.3 Enhance education, awareness-raising and the capacity of individuals and institutions on climate change adaptation, mitigation, impact reduction and early warning systems 13.b Promote capacity-building mechanisms for least developed countries and small island developing States to develop effective planning and management capabilities to address climate change, with a focus on women, youth, local communities and marginalized groups	As demonstrated by the DRC's REDD+ strategy developed in 2012, combating global warming and protecting its natural resources are priorities for the DRC. The Lukolela REDD+ Project will contribute to the implementation of measures to combat climate change and deforestation by reducing the main causes of unplanned deforestation and degradation. In addition, it will support the development of resilient and sustainable agricultural systems that will enable adaptation to climate change. The Project will also promote sustainable fishing and hunting to preserve biodiversity and its regeneration. All of the activities and training provided will also raise awareness among local communities about the importance of protecting forests and developing a sustainable and resilient system for the long term. The Project will also implement savannah protection activities that will enable the protection of savannahs and their biodiversity from fire and allow natural regeneration.	- Number of ha of forest under conservation ; - Number of ha of savannah protected from fire; - Number of tons of carbon dioxide emissions avoided.
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15) 	15.1 By 2020, ensure the conservation, restoration and sustainable use of terrestrial and inland water ecosystems and their services, in particular forests, wetlands, mountains and arid lands, in accordance with international agreements 15.2 By 2020, promote the sustainable management of all types of forests, end deforestation, restore degraded forests and significantly increase global afforestation and reforestation 15.3 By 2030, combat desertification, restore degraded land and soil, including land affected by desertification, drought and floods, and strive to achieve land degradation neutrality. 15.5 Take urgent action to reduce environmental degradation, halt biodiversity loss and, by 2020, protect threatened species and prevent their extinction 15.9 By 2020, integrate the protection of ecosystems and biodiversity into national planning, development mechanisms, poverty reduction strategies and accounting 15.a Mobilize financial resources from all sources and significantly increase them to preserve biodiversity and ecosystems and use them sustainably	In the long term, the Project will help combat the factors driving deforestation and thus restore degraded ecosystems and their biodiversity. Preserving these rich, carbon-rich ecosystems effectively mitigates the effects of climate change. It promotes the resilience of ecosystems and their resources. The concession, located near the Tumba-Lediima reserve, has ecosystems rich in biodiversity (peat bogs, dense forest, etc.) that are vital to preserve. The Project is part of a long-term, sustainable vision that will enable the implementation of viable, sustainable systems that respect the forests and their resources. Agricultural activities developed in the savannahs will restore land degraded by fire. Forest conservation will enable the restoration of ecosystems and the return of biodiversity.	-Number of ha under conservation ; -Number of ha of savannah protected from fire; -Number of hectares under HCV status protected.
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16) 	16.6 Build effective, accountable, and transparent institutions at all levels 16.7 Ensure that decision-making is characterized by dynamism, openness, participation, and representation at all levels 16.10 Ensure public access to information and protect fundamental freedoms, in accordance with national law and international agreements	The core of the Lukolela REDD+ Project methodology consists of strengthening the organizational structure of local communities and decentralized territorial entities (DTEs) based on the model of LDCs and councils for agriculture and rural management (CARGs) recommended by the Ministry of Rural Development. This strengthening will be achieved through the establishment or organizational regeneration of these institutions and their eventual official legal recognition. These participatory governance models will be representative and inclusive, ensuring that there is no gender or ethnic discrimination. In addition, all stages will be accompanied by prior awareness-raising sessions and the obtaining of FPIC in order to guarantee the transparency of activities and the consent of the populations concerned.	-Number of FPIC obtained -Number of LDC created -Number of institutional support of the CARG
17) 	17.1 Improve, in particular through international assistance to developing countries, the mobilization of domestic resources to strengthen national capacity for tax collection and other revenues	The Project contributes to this objective by generating new fiscal revenues for the DRC through taxes, fees, and other contributions linked to carbon finance and land use. It supports the mobilization of domestic resources by contracting with local entrepreneurs, local NGOs, formalizing value chains, increasing taxable activities in rural areas, and strengthening national and local government capacity to capture revenue from forest and land-based sectors.	-Amount of taxes paid to National Government.

2.1.19 Implementation Schedule (CCB, G1.9)

2.1.20 Risks to the Project (CCB, G1.10)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.21 Benefit Permanence (CCB, G1.11)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.1.22 Financial Sustainability (CCB, G1.12)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.2 Without-project Land Use Scenario and Additionality

2.2.1 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation and Land Use Scenarios without the Project (VCS, 3.13; CCB, G2.1)

The Lukolela REDD+ Project was not implemented with the intent of artificially generating greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions for the purpose of their subsequent reduction, removal, or destruction. All historical and ongoing deforestation observed within the project area results from prevailing socio-economic drivers, demographic pressures, entirely independent of any project planning activities.

The project area is situated within the Congo Basin rainforest ecosystem, characterized by dense tropical moist broadleaf forests exhibiting high biodiversity levels and significant carbon storage potential. This ecosystem is globally recognized as a critical biodiversity hotspot.

Historically, the Lukolela concession was predominantly covered by intact and semi-intact tropical forests, which were used intermittently by local communities for subsistence activities, such as hunting, gathering, and small-scale shifting agriculture. Over previous decades, the area was formally allocated as a commercial logging concession and was subject to industrial-scale timber harvesting under regulated forestry operations. Nonetheless, even during its tenure as a logging concession, the area was under increasing pressure from unplanned deforestation and forest degradation caused by local community activities. These pressures – including slash-and-burn agriculture, charcoal production, and informal fuelwood extraction – have intensified in recent years, driven by rapid population growth and the lack of alternative livelihoods. Recognizing these escalating threats, the concession was acquired and converted into a conservation concession, shifting the focus toward mitigating deforestation dynamics in collaboration with local communities.

Environmental conditions prior to project initiation reflect both the ecological richness of the region and the cumulative impacts of human activities. The project zone experiences a tropical humid climate with bimodal rainfall patterns, receiving an average annual precipitation of approximately 1,725 mm, and mean annual temperatures ranging from 24.3 °C to 25.7 °C (Fick, S.E. and Hijmans, R.J., 2017. WorldClim 2: new 1 km spatial resolution climate surfaces for global land areas. *International Journal of Climatology*, 37(12): 4302-4315). Hydrologically, the landscape is interlaced with numerous small rivers and tributaries of the Congo River, causing seasonal flooding in certain lowland areas. The terrain is moderately undulating, with elevations between 295 and 463 meters above sea level, averaging approximately 350 meters (Copernicus DEM, ESA/European Commission, 2020). Soils are predominantly classified as Ferralsols (FRx), typical of humid tropical forest regions. They are characterized by low fertility and high acidity, making them suitable only for short-term cultivation following forest clearing (Batjes NH 2007. SOTER-based soil parameter estimates for Central Africa - DR of Congo, Burundi and Rwanda (SOTWIScaf, version 1.0). Report 2007/02, ISRIC - World Soil Information, Wageningen).

Vegetation within the project area consists largely of closed-canopy primary forest, while the surrounding landscapes include villages and subsistence agricultural plots.

In the absence of the Lukolela REDD+ Project, unplanned deforestation would be expected to continue across the concession. The primary drivers would remain the expansion of slash-and-burn agriculture due to increasing population pressure and land scarcity; growing charcoal production to satisfy regional energy demands; informal timber extraction for local consumption and small-scale trade; and infrastructure development proceeding without integrated land-use planning. Without intervention, these trends are anticipated to result in progressive forest loss and fragmentation, leading to significant declines in carbon stocks and threatening biodiversity. These baseline dynamics have been modeled and quantified in the baseline scenario, capturing the continuation of the conditions existing prior to the project start.

As the baseline scenario aligns with the ongoing land-use dynamics existing prior to the start of the project, further details are provided in Section 3.1.4.

2.2.2 Most-Likely Scenario Justification (CCB, G2.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.2.3 Community and Biodiversity Additionality (CCB, G2.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.2.4 Benefits to be used as Offsets (CCB, G2.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3 Safeguards and Stakeholder Engagement

2.3.1 Stakeholder Identification (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB G1.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.2 Stakeholder Descriptions (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G1.6, G1.13)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.3 Stakeholder Access to Project Documents (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.4 Dissemination of Summary Project Documents (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.5 Informational Meetings with Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.6 Risks from the Project and No Net Harm (VCS, 3.18, 3.19)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.7 Community Costs, Risks, and Benefits (CCB, G3.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.8 Information to Stakeholders on Validation and Verification Process (VCS, 3.18.6, 3.19; CCB, G3.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.9 Site Visit Information and Opportunities to Communicate with Auditor (VCS, 3.18.6; CCB, G3.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.10 Stakeholder Consultations (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G3.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.11 Continued Consultation and Adaptive Management (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G3.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.12 Stakeholder Consultation Channels (CCB, G3.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.13 Stakeholder Participation in Decision-Making and Implementation (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.6)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.14 Anti-Discrimination Assurance (VCS 3.19; CCB, G3.7)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.15 Feedback and Grievance Redress Procedure (VCS, 3.18.4; CCB, G3.8)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.16 Accessibility of the Feedback and Grievance Redress Procedure (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.8)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.17 Worker Training (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.9)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.18 Community Employment Opportunities (VCS, 3.19.13; CCB, G3.10)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.3.19 Occupational Safety Assessment (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.12)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4 Management Capacity

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.1 Project Governance Structures (CCB, G4.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.2 Required Technical Skills (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.3 Management Team Experience (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.4 Project Management Partnerships and Team Development (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.5 Financial Health of Implementing Organization(s) (CCB, G4.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.6 Avoidance of Corruption and Other Unethical Behavior (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.4.7 Commercially Sensitive Information (VCS, 3.5.2 – 3.5.4; CCB Rules, 3.5.13 – 3.5.14)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5 Legal Status and Property Rights

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.1 National and Local Laws (VCS, 3.1, 3.6, 3.7, 3.14, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.6)

The DRC has been committed to and has supported the REDD+ process since 2008, as evidenced by its early selection in the Forest Investment Program (FIP). The FIP is part of the national REDD+ process and serves as the primary source of funding to enable the country to enter an investment phase, undertake the large-scale operational deployment of REDD+, and launch the first sectoral transformation program in 2015. In 2012, the government adopted a national REDD+ strategy ³, which outlines how it can meet its long-term development aspirations through a green economy. This strategy aims to stabilize forest cover across two-thirds of the country's area by 2030 and maintain it thereafter. More recently, the government has developed a large-scale REDD+ program for results-based payments in the Mai Ndombe

³ « Stratégie-cadre Nationale REDD+_RDC_Résumé pr Décideurs_2012.pdf ».

province, with the goal of having a significant impact on the climate and delivering crucial development benefits, while generating unprecedented learning for the FCPF Carbon Fund.

The Project is aligned with the ambitious goals of the FIP and draws inspiration from the actions implemented in Mai Ndombe aimed at establishing a green development program.

Throughout the Project period, **Taranis Operations Limited** (Project Proponent), **Taranis Congo** (concession owner) and **The Shared Wood Company Kongo** (Project operator) will ensure that the Project and all the activities are carried out in accordance with national and international regulations. The Lukolela REDD+ Project complies with all applicable local, district, and national laws, regulations, and standards. Within the project area, none of the proposed project activities violates any law.

Sector	Laws and legal text	Project compliance
<u>Local governance</u>	<u>Legal text:</u> - Law No. 08/012 of July 31, 2008, on fundamental principles relating to the free administration of the provinces; <u>Regulatory text:</u> - Ministerial Decree No. 034/CAB/MIN/ECNEF/2006 of October 2, 2006, on the composition, organization, and functioning of Provincial Forest Advisory Councils;	The Project learned about the structure of local governance and presented its future activities to provincial authorities.
<u>Concession right</u>	<u>Legal text :</u> - Law No. 011/2002, of 29 August 2002, sets forth the rules applicable to the conservation, exploitation and development of forestry resources in all national territory (Forestry Code) - Law No. 73-021 of July 20, 1973, on the general regime governing property, land and real estate, and the regime governing securities, as amended and supplemented by Law No. 80-008 of July 18, 1980. <u>Regulatory text :</u> - Decree No. 011/27 of May 20, 2011, establishing specific rules for the allocation of conservation forest concessions; - Decree No. 14/018 of August 2, 2014, establishing the terms and conditions for the allocation of forest concessions to local communities;	Taranis Congo has obtained the rights to conservation concession No. 03/24 in accordance with the legal procedure for the transfer of conservation rights and the signing of the conservation concession agreement with the DRC government. In addition, Taranis Congo undertakes to pay all taxes related to the concession.

	- Decree No. 09/08, of 8 April 2008 setting out the procedure for the award of exploitation, conservation and other concessions amended by Decree No. 011/25 of May 20, 2011; - Ministerial Order No. 008/CAB/MIN/ECN-T/2008 and No. 082/CAB/MIN/FINANCES/2008 setting the rates of duties, taxes, and fees to be levied on forestry activities at the initiative of the Ministry of the Environment, Nature Conservation, and Tourism; - Ministerial Order No. 022/CAB/MIN/ECN-T/15/Jeb/2008, of 7 August 2008, as amended by Ministerial Order No. 083/CAB/MIN/ECN-T/11/BNME/2013, of 30 September 2013, setting out the procedure of authorization for the transfer, lease, assignment and donation of forestry concessions (Ministerial Order 022/CAB/MIN/ECN-T/15/Jeb/2008).	
<u>REDD+ and environmental project in DRC</u>	<u>Legal text :</u> - Law No. 011/2002, of 29 August 2002, sets forth the rules applicable to the conservation, exploitation and development of forestry resources in all national territory (Forestry Code). - Law No. 11/009 of July 9, 2011, on fundamental principles relating to environmental protection, modified and completed by the Ordinance-Law No.23/007 of March 3, 2023; - Law No. 14/003 of February 11, 2014, on nature conservation modified and completed by the Law No.24/020 of December 30, 2024. <u>Regulatory text :</u> - Decree No. 14/019 of August 2, 2014, establishing the rules for the operation of procedural mechanisms for environmental protection; - Decree No. 13/015 of 29 May 2013 regulating classified installations," which in its Article 11, paragraph 2, makes the issuance of any license to operate a classified installation conditional on the prior completion of an Environmental and Social Impact Assessment, in accordance with Article 21 of "Law No. 11/009 of 9 July 2011 laying down the fundamental principles relating to environmental protection;	Taranis Congo and sWc Kongo, acting on behalf of Taranis Operations Limited, will ensure that the project complies with the legal framework for REDD+ projects in the DRC. The Project will be subject to the homologation process and the necessary studies will be carried out, including the approval and implementation of REDD+ projects with the obtention of the "FPIC" of local communities and an environmental and social impact assessment, which will be validated by the Congolese environmental agency in order to obtain environmental certification. In addition, the terms for distributing the State's share of the proceeds from the sale of carbon credits were set out in the collaboration agreement signed

	- Decree 09/40 of November 26, 2009, on the creation, composition, and organization of the structure for implementing the process of reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, abbreviated as “REDD”; - Ministerial Order No. 047/CAB/MIN/EDD/AA/MML/05/2018, of 9 May 2018 on the homologation process of the REDD+ investments (REDD+ Homologation Regulations); - Interministerial Decree No. 006/CAB/MINETAT-MIN/EDD/EBM/TSB/02/2023 and No. 120/CAB/MIN. FINANCES/2023 of September 15, 2023, establishing the distribution of the State's share of the profits from the sale of carbon credits; - Ministerial Decree number 043/CAB/MIN/ECN-EF/2006 of December 8, 2006 bearing provisions related to environmental and social assessment obligations of projects in the DRC; - Ministerial Decree number 044/CAB/MIN/ECN-EF/2006 of December 8, 2006 creating the organization and functioning of the <i>Groupe d'études environnementales du Congo</i> (GEEC) [the Environmental Studies Group of the Congo]. - Interministerial Decree No. 006/CAB/MIN/EDD/2020 and No. CAB/MIN/FINANCES/2020/069 of July 24, 2020, setting the rates of duties, taxes, and fees to be collected on the initiative of the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development in relation to fauna and flora.	between Taranis Congo and the Democratic Republic of Congo in accordance with Interministerial Decree No. 006/CAB/MINETAT-MIN/EDD/EBM/TSB/02/2023 and No. 120/CAB/MIN. FINANCES/2023 of September 15, 2023.
<u>Biodiversity, hunting and agriculture</u>	<u>Biodiversity and hunting :</u> - Law No. 82-002 of May 28, 1982, regulating hunting; - Ministerial Order No. 020/CAB/MIN/ECN-EF/2006 of May 23, 2006, approving the list of protected animal species in the Democratic Republic of Congo; - Decree No. 014/CAB/MIN/ENV/2004 of April 29, 2004 on measures to implement Law No. 82-002 of May 28, 1982 regulating hunting;	The Project will ensure compliance with laws relating to hunting, agriculture, and biodiversity for all related activities carried out in the concessions.

	- Ministerial Order No. CAB/MIN/AFFET/276/2002, of 5 November 2002 listing protected species. - <u>Agriculture</u> : - Law number 11/022 of December 24, 2011 bearing fundamental principles related to agriculture gives rise to the Agricultural Code.	
<u>Others</u>	The Lukolela REDD+ Project is also required to comply with the following legal and regulatory texts: - Law No. 14/011 of 17 June 2014 regulating the electricity sector in the Democratic Republic of Congo. - "Law No. 15/026 of 31 December 2015 concerning water management. - Decree-Law No. 081 of 2 July 1998 on the territorial and administrative organization of the Democratic Republic of Congo.	The Project will ensure compliance with all other laws applicable to the activities carried out in the concession.

Other multilateral environmental agreements have been signed or ratified by the DRC, and the Project will also ensure compliance with the following provisions:

- The Convention on Biological Diversity (June 5, 1992); - The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (June 4, 1992);
- The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (October 17, 1995);
- The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species (CITES) (March 3, 1973);
- The Convention on Wetlands of International Importance, especially as Waterfowl Habitat, or RAMSAR (February 2, 1971);
- The Convention Concerning the Protection of the World's Cultural and Natural Heritage (November 23, 1972);
- The Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals, Bonn, June 23, 1979;
- The International Plant Protection Convention, signed in Rome on December 6, 1951;
- The African Convention on the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources, Algiers, September 15, 1968;
- The Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety to the Convention on Biological Diversity (2000);

- The Vienna Convention for the Protection of the Ozone Layer and the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer (1987) as amended;
- The Phyto-Sanitary Convention for Africa, signed Kinshasa, on September 13, 1975;
- The Stockholm Convention on Persistent Organic Pollutants (2001);
- The Rotterdam Convention on the Prior Informed Consent Procedure for Certain Hazardous Chemicals and Pesticides in International Trade (1999);
- The Vienna Convention for the Protection of the Ozone Layer and the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer (1987) as amended;
- The Kyoto Protocol to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, Kyoto, Japan (1997);
- The Paris Agreement, Paris, France (2015).

2.5.2 Relevant Laws and Regulations Related to Worker's Rights (VCS, 3.18.2; CCB, G3.11)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.3 Human Rights (VCS, 3.19)

2.5.4 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage (VCS, 3.18, 3.19)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.5 Statutory and Customary Property Rights (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.6 Recognition of Property Rights (VCS, 3.7, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.7 Free, Prior and Informed Consent (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G5.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.8 Benefit Sharing Mechanisms (VCS, 3.18, 3.19;)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.9 Property Rights Protection (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.10 Illegal Activity Identification (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G5.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.11 Ongoing Disputes (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.12 Approvals (CCB, G5.7)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.13 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs (VCS, 3.23; CCB G5.9)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.5.13.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program, or any other form of community, social, or biodiversity unit or credit?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If yes, provide required evidence of no double issuance as outlined by the VCS Standard and the CCB Standards. Include all relevant information about the community, social, or biodiversity credit.

2.5.13.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Has the project registered under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If yes, provide the registration number and the date of project inactivity under the other GHG program.

Is the project active under the other program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Project proponents, or their authorized representative, must attest that the project is no longer active in the other GHG program in the Registration Representation.

2.5.13.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide the program name(s), reason(s) and date for the rejection, justification of eligibility under the VCS Program, and any other relevant information.

2.5.14 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions (VCS, 3.24)

2.5.14.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide all required evidence of no double claiming as outlined by the VCS Standard.

2.5.14.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide all required evidence of no double claiming as outlined by the VCS Standard.

2.5.14.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes:

Is the project proponent(s) or authorized representative a buyer or seller of the product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes:

Has the project proponent(s) or authorized representative posted a public statement on their website saying, “Carbon credits may be issued through Verified Carbon Standard project [project ID] for the greenhouse gas emission reductions or removals associated with [project proponent or authorized representative organization name(s)] [name of product(s) whose emissions footprint is changed by the project activities].”?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes to all:

Provide evidence of the public statement. Evidence must be provided in this section or in an appendix.

2.6 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

2.6.1 Leakage Management (VCS, 3.11, 3.15)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

2.6.2 Further Information

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3 CLIMATE

3.1 Application of Methodology

3.1.1 Title and Reference of Methodology (VCS, 3.1)

Type (methodology, tool, module)	Reference ID (if applicable)	Title	Version
Methodology	VM0007	REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+ MF)	1.8
Tool	VT0001	Tool for the Demonstration and Assessment of Additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project Activities	3.0

Module	VMD0001	Estimation of carbon stocks in the above- and belowground biomass in live tree and non-tree pools (CP-AB)	1.1
Module	VMD0007	Estimation of baseline carbon stock changes and GHG emissions from unplanned deforestation and unplanned wetland degradation (BL-UP)	3.3
Module	VMD0010	Estimation of emissions from activity shifting for avoided unplanned deforestation and avoiding unplanned wetland degradation (LK-ASU)	1.2
Module	VMD0013	Estimation of GHG emissions from biomass and peat burning (E-BPB)	1.2
Module	VMD0015	Methods for monitoring of GHG emissions and removals (M-REDD)	2.2
Module	VMD0016	Methods for stratification of the project area (X-STR)	1.2
Module	VMD0017	Estimation of uncertainty for REDD project activities (X-UNC)	2.2
Tool	NPRT	AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool	4.2

3.1.2 Applicability of Methodology (VCS, 3.1)

Reference ID/Title	Applicability condition	Justification of conformance
VM0007 [1]	Land in the project area has qualified as forest for at least the 10 years prior to the project start date. Mangroves excluded from height requirement.	Land in the project area has qualified as forest for at least the 10 years (i.e. before 2014) prior to the project start date (2025), as confirmed by the Joint Research Centre (JRC) Tropical Moist Forest (TMF) dataset ⁴ , which serves as the forest benchmark map. No mangroves are present in the project area.

⁴ C. Vancutsem, F. Achard, J.-F. Pekel, G. Vieilledent, S. Carboni, D. Simonetti, J. Gallego, L.E.O.C. Aragão, R. Nasi. Long-term (1990-2019) monitoring of forest cover changes in the humid tropics. Science Advances 2021

VM0007 [2]	Where land within the project area is peatland or tidal wetlands and emissions from the SOC pool are deemed significant, the relevant WRC modules are applied alongside other relevant modules	Peatlands have been identified in portions of the project area using peat thickness and extent data provided by Crezee et al. (2022) ⁵ . In accordance with VM0007 requirements, a significance assessment of potential Soil Organic Carbon (SOC) emissions from these peat areas has been conducted using the test described in Annex 1 of VM0007. The results demonstrated that the anticipated SOC emissions are deemed not significant (de minimis). As a result, the Wetlands Restoration and Conservation (WRC) modules are not applied
VM0007 [3]	Baseline deforestation is unplanned (AUDef) or planned (APDef).	The baseline deforestation is unplanned (AUDef), primarily driven by shifting agriculture, charcoal production, and fuelwood collection.
VM0007 [4]	Flooding agricultural lands or intensifying livestock production via feed-lots or manure lagoons for leakage prevention is not allowed.	Project activities do not involve flooding agricultural lands or livestock intensification. Proposed land uses include agroforestry and low-intensity subsistence agriculture.
VM0007 [5]	Baseline agents of deforestation: clear land for tree harvesting or small-scale ag., lack legal right to deforest, and are residents or immigrants.	Baseline agents are local households practicing slash-and-burn agriculture without formal land tenure.
VM0007 [6]	Post-deforestation land use is reforestation	Not applicable. The baseline post-deforestation land use is agricultural expansion, not reforestation.
VT0001 [1]	AFOLU activities same or similar to the proposed activity must not violate any applicable law, even if not enforced.	All AFOLU activities implemented in the project comply with national and provincial laws of the Democratic Republic of Congo, including forestry, land tenure, and environmental regulations. Legal compliance has been assessed and documented in the legal compliance section.
VT0001 [2]	Use of this tool requires the baseline methodology to justify the most plausible baseline scenario with a stepwise approach.	The REDD baseline scenario has been developed following the stepwise approach outlined in the VCS guidance and REDD-MF methodology, where multiple alternatives were evaluated before selecting the most plausible baseline scenario.
VMD0001 [1]	This module is applicable to all forest types and age classes.	The module is applicable as the project area comprises tropical moist forests.

⁵ Crezee, B., Dargie, G.C., Ewango, C.E.N. *et al.* Mapping peat thickness and carbon stocks of the central Congo Basin using field data. *Nat. Geosci.* **15**, 639–644 (2022)

VMD0007 [1]	Applicable for estimating baseline emissions from unplanned deforestation in forest land converting to non-forest land. Landscape can be mosaic, transition, or frontier.	The module applies as the project baseline includes unplanned deforestation with patterns matching transition configurations, as evidenced by historical spatial analysis of deforestation.
VMD0007 [2]	Baseline agents: (i) clear land for settlements, agriculture, ranching or aquaculture (not large-scale); (ii) lack legal right to deforest; (iii) are residents or immigrants in the reference region.	Baseline deforestation agents in the reference region are primarily smallholder farmers and charcoal producers. They operate without legal rights to clear land and are either local residents or migrants.
VMD0010 [1]	Applicable for estimating carbon stock changes and GHG emissions from displaced activities causing deforestation or wetland degradation outside the project area.	The project applies this module to estimate carbon stock changes and GHG emissions from potential displacement of deforestation activities outside the project area.
VMD0010 [2]	Activities subject to displacement include conversion of forest land to grazing/cropland/other land uses, or conversion of intact/partially degraded wetlands to drained/degraded wetlands.	Potential displaced activities include primarily the conversion of forest land to cropland, driven by local agricultural expansion pressures.
VMD0010 [3]	Mandatory if module BL-UP is used to define the baseline ; full compliance with BL-UP applicability conditions required.	Module BL-UP is used in this project. All associated applicability conditions are met.
VMD0013 [1]	Applicable to REDD project activities with emissions from biomass burning.	Biomass burning could occur in the baseline due to slash-and-burn agriculture and occasional uncontrolled fires. Inclusion of fire emissions in the baseline is optional under this module. The project is evaluating whether to include these emissions in baseline accounting or conservatively exclude them.
VMD0015 [1]	Strata as defined in baseline modules are fixed and may not be changed without baseline revision.	Baseline strata differentiating mineral soils and peatlands have been established during initial project design under the REDD+ MF methodology. No changes will occur unless a formal baseline revision is undertaken.
VMD0015 [2]	Requirements for logging activities	Not applicable. No logging activities are planned within the project boundary.
VMD0016 [1]	Module must be used to delineate peat vs non-peat	Peat vs. non-peat zones have been delineated using peat thickness and extent data from

	and stratify peat by depth and emission characteristics unless SOC emissions are de minimis.	Crezee et al. (2022). An assessment of the significance of SOC emissions was conducted following the test described in Annex 1 of VM0007, which determined that anticipated SOC emissions are de minimis in the context of the methodology.
VMD0017 [1]	Mandatory module when using REDD+ MF methodology, applicable for estimating uncertainty in emissions/removals from REDD and WRC activities.	The project uses the REDD+ MF methodology, therefore application of VMD0017 is mandatory. The project complies with this requirement.
VMD0017 [2]	Covers uncertainties in deforestation/degradation rates, carbon pool stock estimates and changes, peat emissions, and project emissions.	The project's uncertainty assessment includes deforestation rates, carbon stock estimates, and project emissions, ensuring that all parameters required by the module are covered.
VMD0017 [3]	If uncertainty value is unknown or not easily calculable, a justified conservative estimate can be used, including 0% if indisputable.	Where field data is not available, the project uses conservative estimates based on peer-reviewed literature and IPCC defaults.
VMD0017 [4]	A 95% confidence interval with a half-width $\leq 15\%$ of the recorded value must be targeted, particularly for carbon stock measurements.	The sampling design for forest carbon stocks inventory and estimation targets a 95% confidence level and $\leq 15\%$ relative precision. Random sampling, sample size optimization, and QA/QC procedures support this objective, in accordance with REDD+ MF requirements.

3.1.3 Project Boundary (VCS, 3.12)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

Define the project boundary and identify the relevant GHG sources, sinks, and reservoirs for the project and baseline scenarios (including leakage if applicable). Add rows as needed.

Source	Gas	Included?	Justification/explanation
Baseline	CO ₂		
	CH ₄		
	N ₂ O		

Source		Gas	Included?	Justification/explanation
Project	Source 2	Other		
		CO ₂		
		CH ₄		
		N ₂ O		
		Other		
	Source 1	CO ₂		
		CH ₄		
		N ₂ O		
		Other		
	Source 2	CO ₂		
		CH ₄		
		N ₂ O		
		Other		

Provide a diagram or map of the project boundary, showing clearly the physical locations of the various installations or management activities taking place as part of the project activity based on the description provided in Section 2.1.1 (Description of the Project Activity) above.

Include in the diagram or map the locations of where the various measures are taking place, and any reference areas and leakage belts.

3.1.4 Baseline Scenario (VCS, 3.13)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.1.5 Additionality (VCS, 3.14)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.1.5.1 Regulatory Surplus (VCS, 3.14)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.1.5.2 [Additionality Methods](#) (VCS, 3.14)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.1.6 [Methodology Deviations](#) (VCS, 3.20)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.2 [Quantification of Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Removals](#)

3.2.1 [Baseline Emissions](#) (VCS, 3.15)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.2.2 [Project Emissions](#) (VCS, 3.15)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.2.3 [Leakage Emissions](#) (VCS 2.5, 3.2, 3.6, 3.15, 4.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.2.4 [Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals](#) (VCS, 3.15, 4.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.3 [Monitoring](#)

3.3.1 [Data and Parameters Available at Validation](#) (VCS, 3.16)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.3.2 [Data and Parameters Monitored](#) (VCS, 3.16)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.3.3 [Monitoring Plan](#) (VCS, 3.16, 3.20)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.3.4 Dissemination of Monitoring Plan and Results (VCS, 3.18; CCB, CL4.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.4 Optional Criterion: Climate Change Adaptation Benefits

3.4.1 Regional Climate Change Scenarios (CCB, GL1.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.4.2 Climate Change Impacts (CCB, GL1.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

3.4.3 Measures Needed and Designed for Adaptation (CCB, GL1.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4 COMMUNITY

4.1 Without-Project Community Scenario

4.1.1 Descriptions of Communities at Project Start (CCB, CM1.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.1.2 Interactions between Communities and Community Groups (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM1.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.1.3 High Conservation Values (CCB, CM1.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.1.4 Without-Project Scenario: Community (CCB, CM1.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.2 Net Positive Community Impacts

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.2.1 Expected Community Impacts (CCB, CM2.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.2.2 Negative Community Impact Mitigation (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM2.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.2.3 Net Positive Community Well-Being (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM2.3, GL1.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.2.4 High Conservation Values Protected (CCB, CM2.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.3 Other Stakeholder Impacts

4.3.1 Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.3.2 Mitigation of Negative Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.3.3 Net Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.4 Community Impact Monitoring

4.4.1 Community Monitoring Plan (CCB, CM4.1, CM4.2, GL1.4, GL2.2, GL2.3, GL2.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.4.2 Monitoring Plan Dissemination (CCB, CM4.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5 Optional Criterion: Exceptional Community Benefits

4.5.1 Exceptional Community Criteria (CCB, GL2.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.2 Short-term and Long-term Community Benefits (CCB, GL2.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.3 Community Participation Risks (CCB, GL2.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.4 Marginalized and/or Vulnerable Community Groups (CCB, GL2.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.5 Net Impacts on Women (CCB, GL2.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.6 Benefit Sharing Mechanisms (CCB, GL2.6)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.7 Benefits, Costs, and Risks Communication (VCS, 3.18; CCB, GL2.7)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.8 Governance and Implementation Structures (CCB, GL2.8)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

4.5.9 Smallholders/Community Members Capacity Development (CCB, GL2.9)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5 BIODIVERSITY

5.1 Without-Project Biodiversity Scenario

5.1.1 Existing Conditions (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B1.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.1.2 High Conservation Values (CCB, B1.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.1.3 Without-project Scenario: Biodiversity (CCB, B1.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2 Net Positive Biodiversity Impacts

5.2.1 Expected Biodiversity Changes (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.2 Mitigation Measures (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.3 Net Positive Biodiversity Impacts (CCB, B2.2, GL1.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.4 High Conservation Values Protected (CCB, B2.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.5 Species Used (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.5, B2.6)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.6 Invasive Species (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.5)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.7 GMO Exclusion (CCB, B2.7)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.8 Inputs Justification (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.8)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.2.9 Waste Products (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.9)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.3 Offsite Biodiversity Impacts

5.3.1 Negative Offsite Biodiversity Impacts (CCB, B3.1) and Mitigation Measures (CCB, B3.2)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.3.2 Net Offsite Biodiversity Benefits (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B3.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.4 Biodiversity Impact Monitoring

5.4.1 Biodiversity Monitoring Plan (CCB, B4.1, B4.2, GL1.4, GL3.4)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.4.2 Biodiversity Monitoring Plan Dissemination (CCB, B4.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.5 Optional Criterion: Exceptional Biodiversity Benefits

5.5.1 High Biodiversity Conservation Priority Status (CCB, GL3.1)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

5.5.2 Trigger Species Population Trends (CCB, GL3.2, GL3.3)

This section is under development. In accordance with the VCS Registration and Issuance Process v4.6, all information will be finalized and included prior to the validation.

Bibliography :

1. CAFI (2012), « STRATÉGIE-CADRE NATIONALE REDD+ DE LA RÉPUBLIQUE DÉMOCRATIQUE DU CONGO », République Démocratique du Congo, https://www.cafi.org/sites/default/files/2022-04/Strate%CC%81gie-cadre%20Nationale%20REDD%2B_RDC_Re%CC%81sume%CC%81%20pr%20De%CC%81cides_urs_2012.pdf, consulté le 19/03/2025

APPENDIX 1: STAKEHOLDER DESCRIPTION TABLE

Use this appendix, if necessary, to identify stakeholders and fulfill Section 2.3.2 above. Modify the table, if necessary, to suit the project activities, or delete if not used.

Stakeholder	Rights, interest, and overall relevance to the project
Identify communities and any community groups within them, any cross-cutting community groups, and list other stakeholders.	

APPENDIX 2: PROJECT ACTIVITIES AND THEORY OF CHANGE TABLE

Use this appendix, if applicable, to identify project activities and fulfill the requirements of Section 2.1.17 above. This is an example of just one method of representing the theory of change. Results chains/flow diagrams are another effective way to represent the theory of change. Modify the table, if necessary, to suit the project activities, or delete if not used.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	

APPENDIX 3: PROJECT RISKS TABLE

Use this appendix to identify and summarize the project risks and fulfill the requirements of Sections 2.3.6, 2.3.17, 2.5, and 5.2.1– 5.2.9, above. Where no risk is identified, write 'No risk identified' and provide justification in the third column. Add rows as needed.

	Identified risk(s)	Potential impact of risk on stakeholders, ecosystem health, and biodiversity	Mitigation or preventative measure(s) taken
Natural and human induced risks to stakeholders' wellbeing			
Risks to stakeholder participation			
Working conditions			
Safety of women and girls			
Safety of minority and marginalized groups, including children			
Pollutants (air, noise, discharges to water, generation of waste, and release of hazardous materials and chemical pesticides and fertilizers)			
Discrimination			

Sexual harassment			
Equal pay for equal work			
Gender equity in labor and work			
Forced labor ⁶			
Child labor			
Human trafficking			
Recognition of, respect of, and promotion of the rights to IPs, LCs and customary rights holders			
Preserving and protecting cultural heritage			
Protecting and preserving property rights, customary rights, or protecting legal or customary tenure/access rights to territories, property, and resources, including collective and/or conflicting rights			

⁶ The identified risks and commensurate mitigation or preventative measure(s) for forced labor, child labor, and human trafficking, must be inclusive of staff and contracted workers employed by third parties.

Impacts on biodiversity and ecosystems			
Soil degradation and soil erosion			
Water consumption and stress			
Habitats (and areas needed for habitat connectivity) for rare, threatened, and endangered species			
Areas needed for habitat connectivity			
Invasive species			
Ecosystem conversion			
[Additional risk identified]			

APPENDIX 4: COMMERCIALY SENSITIVE INFORMATION

Use the table below to describe the commercially sensitive information included in the project description to be excluded in the public version.

Section	Information	Justification

APPENDIX X: <TITLE OF APPENDIX>

Use appendices for supporting information. Delete this appendix (title and instructions) where no appendix is required.